

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

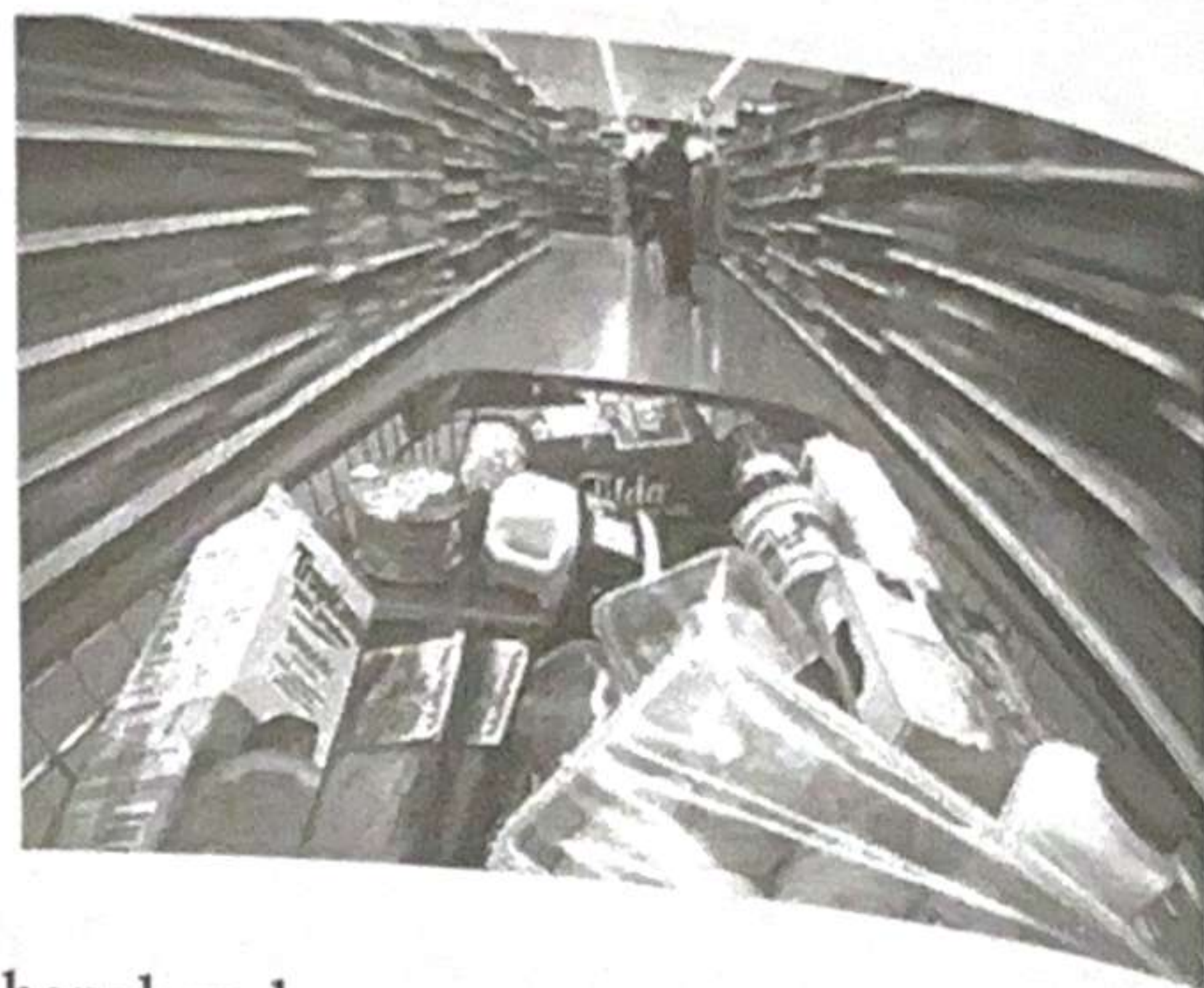
PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a local newspaper:

Travelling North Becomes New Trend

Many will have noted the growing trend of Hong Kong residents travelling north to Shenzhen. The activities on these trips may include leisure activities and even medical services.

According to the latest data from the Immigration Department, 53 million trips were made by Hong Kong residents heading north in 2023. Since 2019, the consumption pattern of Hong Kong people in Shenzhen has gradually shifted from spending on leisure activities to everyday purchases, from dining and entertainment to medical check-ups, grocery shopping and even real estate purchases.



Take supermarket shopping as an example. Sam's Club in Shenzhen has recently become a hit among families from Hong Kong. During weekends and holidays, it is common to see Hong Kong people stocking up on groceries and also enjoying dining after shopping.

Aaron Chan spent his New Year holidays in Shenzhen, during which he tried hot pot and barbecue and drank a lot of milk tea. "The cost of a good meal is half the price. In Shenzhen, you are spoilt for choice and the fruit and vegetables are much cheaper," he stated.

Apart from being cheaper and the variety it offers, Shenzhen is attracting more people because of its high-quality services. A visitor from Hong Kong, Sally Wu, said that she had noticed great improvements in the quality of service in Shenzhen over the last few years. "For example, service staff there will proactively inform you about discount offers, and their friendly attitude makes you feel comfortable," she added.

Your group is working on a project on the changing leisure activities of Hong Kong people. You are preparing a presentation about the trend of travelling to Shenzhen. You might want to talk about:

- why trips to Shenzhen are becoming popular
- why some Hong Kong people prefer Shenzhen to other places
- how Hong Kong businesses could keep people in the city during holidays
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What do you do at weekends?
2. Have you ever been to Shenzhen?
3. Would you like to travel to Shenzhen with your family?
4. What would you do on a family trip to Shenzhen?
5. Do you think the trend of Hong Kong people travelling to Shenzhen will continue?
6. Apart from going to Shenzhen, how could Hong Kong people spend their free time?
7. Do you think it is convenient to make everyday purchases in Shenzhen?
8. How will the travel habits of Hong Kong people change in the future?